

Shaping the land

The surface of our planet never stops changing. Over millions of years, land is slowly worn away by wind, rain, and rivers. Floods, volcanoes, and earthquakes can change the shape of the land in just a few hours.

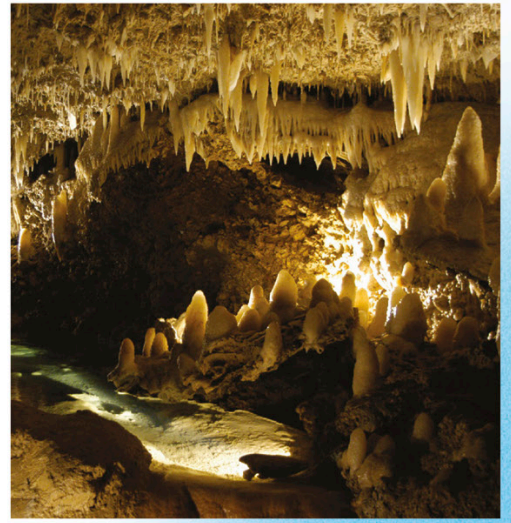


River power

The Grand Canyon formed over millions of years as the Colorado River slowly wore down the rock deeper.

Going underground

Caves form when rain seeps underground and eats away at soft rock such as limestone.



Coastal shapes

Powerful waves shape the coastlines around the world's oceans.



Bays form where waves wear into areas of softer rock along the coast.



Headlands are areas of harder rock that have not been worn away.



Sea arches form when waves open up cracks in headlands.



Sea stacks are pillars of rock left in the sea after an arch collapses.



Glaciers at work

Glaciers are huge rivers of ice that flow slowly off snowcapped mountains. Broken rock sticks to the bottom of the glacier, which then wears away the land like sandpaper, carving out a deep, U-shaped valley.

